TidyTuesday Week 33

Pranay Gundam

Wednesday 12th August, 2026

Contents

1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

This week the machine, in its infinite wisdom, decided to introduce a chained index of urban services prices to a discontinued one-week AMERIBOR interest rate. Truly the meet-cute nobody asked for. And wouldn't you know it, the raw regression came back with an R-squared of 0.93 and a p-value with more zeros after the decimal point than I have hobbies. Ninety-three percent! Break out the champagne, call the Nobel committee, we've cracked the deep and eternal bond between the price of a haircut and the cost of borrowing money for seven days.

Except, of course, we did the responsible thing and stripped out the shared trend, at which point the relationship staggered like a toddler and collapsed to an R-squared of about 0.23. It stays technically "significant" at the detrended level (p around 0.014, if you insist on caring), but let's be honest, that's the statistical equivalent of a relationship surviving only because both parties happened to be walking the same direction. Services prices go up over time. Interest rates did their little thing over their brief, doomed lifespan. Two lines drifting through space, mistaken for soulmates. Classic trend mirage, and this project exists mostly to point and laugh at exactly this.

The August 12 pairing, meanwhile, was a masterclass in the machine embarrassing itself. It matched Swiss National Bank interventions buying dollars against deutschmarks (a series that heroically ended in 1998) with a manufacturers' unfilled-orders ratio for transportation equipment. The problem: their observation windows barely overlap, so the regression served up a coefficient of exactly zero, an R-squared of roughly 0.0000000000000003, and a p-value of "nan," which is math's polite way of saying "please stop." When the smallest eigenvalue is literally zero, you know the design matrix has given up and gone home. No relationship, no drama, no data really — just a singular matrix quietly weeping.

As always, the standard reminder: these are randomly paired economic series flung together for entertainment, and none of it implies causation, correlation worth trusting, or anything a reasonable adult should repeat at a party. Spurious is the house style here. If anything held up this week, it was mostly the servers running the joke. See you next time, when the algorithm inevitably tries to marry pig iron production to Google searches for "am I okay."

2 Date: 2026-08-10

Series ID: SUUR0000SAS

This series is titled Chained Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: Services in U.S. City Average and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 1999=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1999-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01.The popularity of this series is 3.

Series ID: AMBOR1W

This series is titled 1-Week AMERIBOR Term Structure of Interest Rates (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Daily. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2021-06-20 and the observation end date is 2023-12-27.The popularity of this series is 2.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_AMBOR1W	**R-squared:**	0.930
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.927
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	319.1
Date:	Mon, 10 Aug 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	2.29e-15
Time:	12:39:09	**Log-Likelihood:**	-23.378
No. Observations:	26	**AIC:**	50.76
Df Residuals:	24	**BIC:**	53.27
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-50.4524	2.976	-16.953	0.000	-56.595	-44.310
value_fred_SUUR0000SAS	0.2849	0.016	17.863	0.000	0.252	0.318

Omnibus:	3.117	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.261
Prob(Omnibus):	0.210	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	2.425
Skew:	-0.614	**Prob(JB):**	0.297
Kurtosis:	2.147	**Cond. No.**	4.58e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 4.58e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

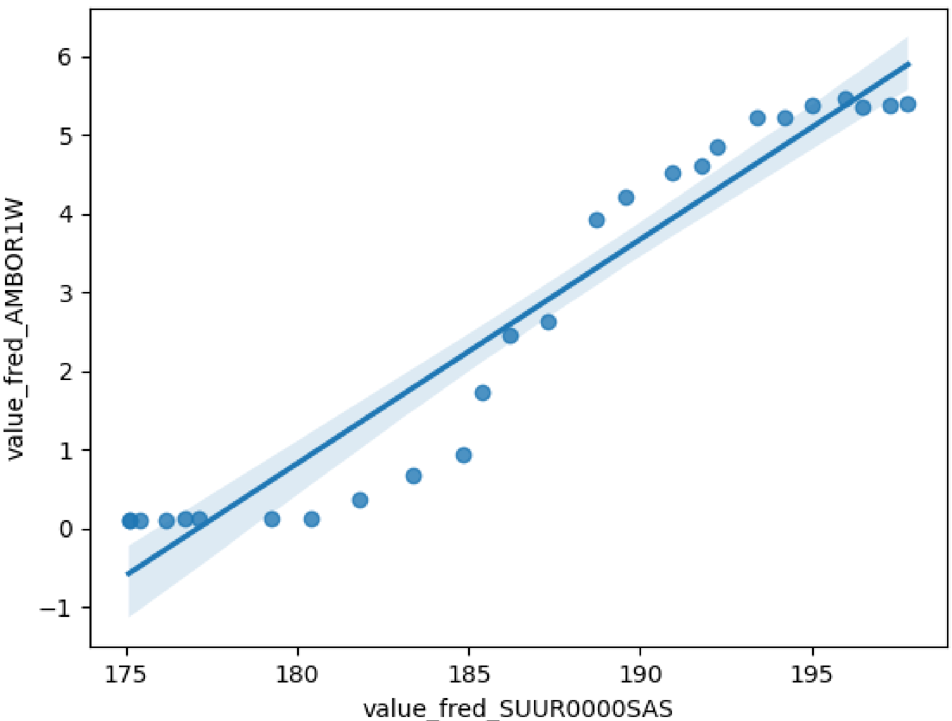

Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-10

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_AMBOR1W_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.227
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.195
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	7.062
Date:	Mon, 10 Aug 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.0138
Time:	12:39:09	**Log-Likelihood:**	-23.173
No. Observations:	26	**AIC:**	50.35
Df Residuals:	24	**BIC:**	52.86
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P>$\lvert$t$\rvert$**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-1.455e-11	0.120	-1.21e-10	1.000	-0.249	0.249
value_fred_SUUR0000SAS_detrended	0.3703	0.139	2.657	0.014	0.083	0.658

Omnibus:	3.443	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.285
Prob(Omnibus):	0.179	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	3.012
Skew:	-0.790	**Prob(JB):**	0.222
Kurtosis:	2.467	**Cond. No.**	1.16

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

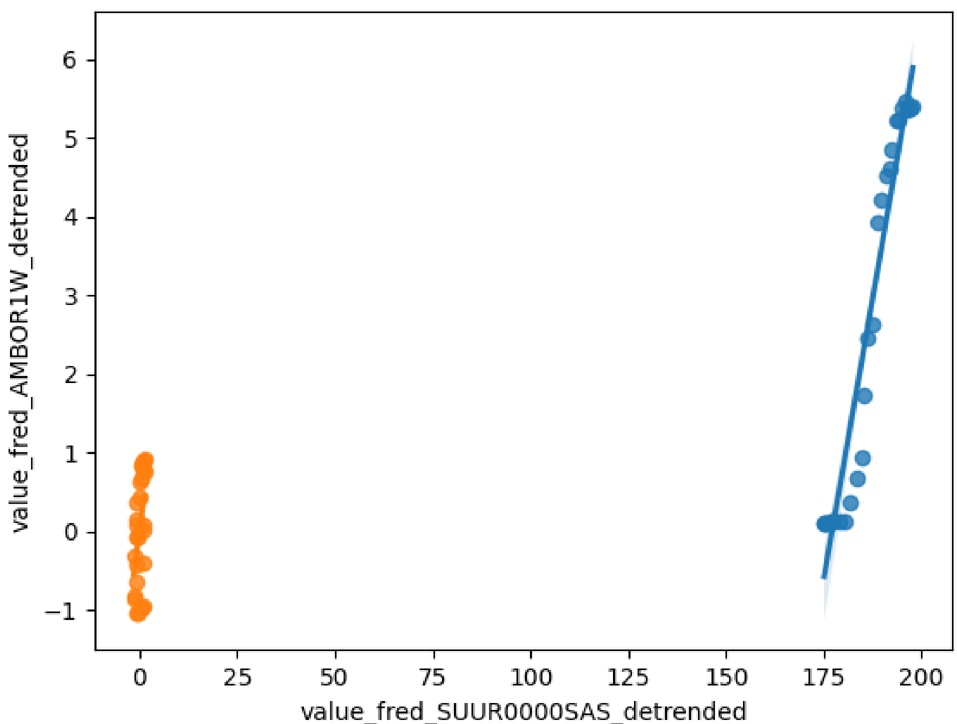

Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-10

3 Date: 2026-08-12

Series ID: CHINTDUSDDM

This series is titled Swiss Intervention: Swiss National Bank Purchases of USD against DEM (Millions of USD) and has a frequency of Daily, 7-Day. The units are Millions of USD and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1975-01-01 and the observation end date is 1998-12-31.The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: U36SUS

This series is titled Manufacturers' Unfilled Orders to Shipments Ratios: Transportation Equipment and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Ratio and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1992-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_U36SUS	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.000
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	nan
Date:	Wed, 12 Aug 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	nan
Time:	12:39:50	**Log-Likelihood:**	-151.34
No. Observations:	84	**AIC:**	304.7
Df Residuals:	83	**BIC:**	307.1
Df Model:	0		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	9.3852	0.161	58.316	0.000	9.065	9.705
value_fred_CHINTDUSDDM	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	19.125	**Durbin-Watson:**	1.105
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	23.295
Skew:	1.168	**Prob(JB):**	8.74e-06
Kurtosis:	4.095	**Cond. No.**	inf

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The smallest eigenvalue is 0. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity problems or that the design matrix is singular.

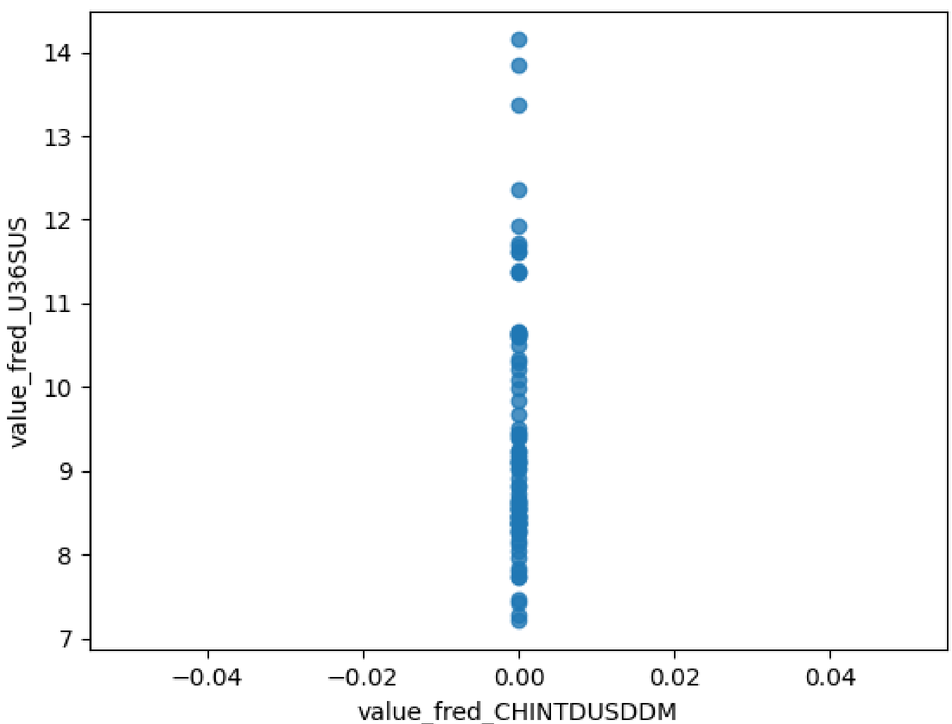

Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-12

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_U36SUS_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.000
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	nan
Date:	Wed, 12 Aug 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	nan
Time:	12:39:50	**Log-Likelihood:**	-134.10
No. Observations:	84	**AIC:**	270.2
Df Residuals:	83	**BIC:**	272.6
Df Model:	0		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-8.19e-13	0.131	-6.25e-12	1.000	-0.261	0.261
value_fred_CHINTDUSDDM_detrended	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	21.603	**Durbin-Watson:**	1.662
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	27.747
Skew:	1.266	**Prob(JB):**	9.44e-07
Kurtosis:	4.233	**Cond. No.**	inf

Notes:
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strong multicollinearity problems or that the design matrix is singular.

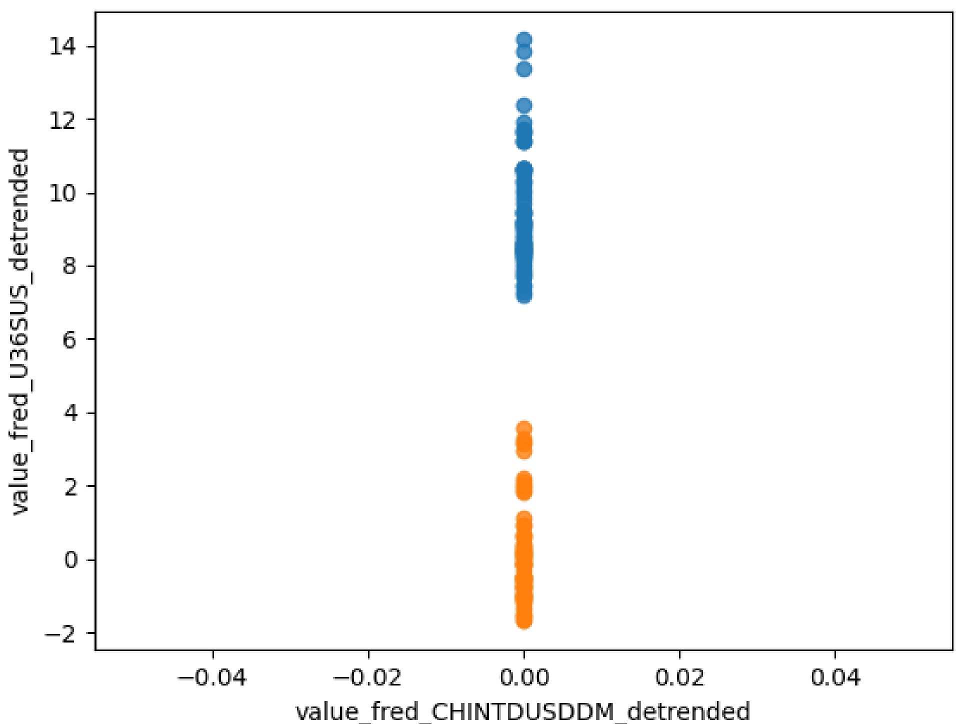

Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-12